approximately 3.5 hours. A range of surgeries, including those for prostate cancer and bladder cancer, can be performed using this technology. In the United States, robots are involved in about 90% of surgeries. While the cost in the US is notably high, the robotic surgery in Jaipur has been incorporated into the Chiranjeevi scheme, ensuring patients do not face financial barriers, and the entire treatment remains free.

In conclusion, Rajasthan has emerged as a healthcare hub not only within India but also on the global stage. The state has witnessed transformative changes, from becoming a sought-after destination for medical tourism to achieving groundbreaking advancements in medical education and treatment techniques. With an impressive number of hospital beds, a growing network of medical colleges, and pioneering efforts in robotic surgery, Rajasthan's healthcare sector is paving the way for a healthier and brighter future.

SMS Hospital doctors achieved a remarkable feat by performing the country's first-ever robotic technique surgery in a government hospital. This achievement holds significance not only in Rajasthan but throughout northern India

ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE AYUSH DEPARTMENT IN EXPANDING HEALTHCARE SERVICES

The AYUSH (Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, and Homeopathy) Department in Rajasthan has made significant strides in enhancing healthcare services across the state. As of now, 14 colleges, comprising 6 Ayurveda and 8 Yoga and Naturopathy institutions, are operational in various cities including Jaipur, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Ajmer, Kota, Sikar, Udaipur, and Jodhpur. Additionally, a Homeopathic college, affiliated with Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan Rajasthan Ayurveda University in Jodhpur, is functioning within the university premises in Jodhpur, with another branch in Kekri (Ajmer) dedicated to the expansion of Ayush education. The recent addition of an



Ayurveda Nursing College in Bharatpur has further enriched the academic landscape, commencing its academic session in 2022-23. Plans are underway to establish an Ayurveda College in Taranagar (Churu), a Yoga and Naturopathy integrated College in Nathdwara (Rajsamand), a Unani College at the Rajasthan Ayurveda College in Jodhpur, and a Homeopathic College in Bharatpur.

*The AYUSH Department has also focused on improving healthcare infrastructure, with the establishment of AYUSH Hospitals in 83 blocks, where integrated medical facilities offering Ayurveda, Unani, and Homeopathy services are readily available. Moreover, integrated hospitals have been set up in six district headquarters. The department has expanded its outreach by developing 1000 dispensaries, comprising 958 Ayurveda, 22 Homeopathic, and 20 Unani centers, which now serve as Ayush Health and Wellness Centres. To bolster Homeopathy and Unani treatments, the department has inaugurated three new homeopathy dispensaries, a hospital, and 225 block dispensaries. Furthermore, it has sanctioned posts for Unani doctors and nurses/compounders at 100 block Ayush dispensaries, strengthening the healthcare workforce.

In a bid to promote research in the field of Ayush, the Rajasthan State Ayush Research Centre is in the process of being established in Ajmer. Additionally, plans are afoot to create a Centre of Excellence in Panchkarma at the Integrated Ayush College in Chaksu and an International Centre of Excellence in Panchkarma at Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan Rajasthan Ayurveda College in Jodhpur.

The department is also exploring the concept of Medi-Tourism Wellness Centres, with a pilot project underway in Nathdwara (Rajsamand). Efforts are being made to establish Ayush Medi-Tourism Centres at tourist and religious destinations through public-private partnerships, promising to blend wellness and tourism seamlessly.

In terms of human resources, the department has made significant appointments, including 595 Ayurveda Medical Officers, 33 Yoga and Naturopathy Medical Officers, and 11 Unani Medical Officers. Additionally, 997 junior Ayurveda nurses/compounders have been recruited, along with 63 junior assistants and 77 attendants appointed on compassionate grounds. Over the past four years, a total of 1776 positions have been filled, and the department has advertised vacancies for 787 Ayurveda Medical Officers, 358 Homeopathy Medical Officers, and 249 Unani Medical Officers.

Notably, a longstanding demand for stipend parity for undergraduate (UG) and postgraduate (PG) students in Ayurveda Colleges in Udaipur has been addressed, bringing their stipends in line with their counterparts in Allopathy. This change also extends to UG and PG students of Ayurveda University in Jodhpur, marking a significant step toward recognizing the value of Ayush education.

To summarise, the AYUSH Department of Rajasthan has been aggressive in increasing healthcare services, improving research possibilities, and strengthening the healthcare staff, all while prioritising the welfare of students pursuing Ayush education. These accomplishments highlight the department's dedication to provide comprehensive and integrated healthcare to the people of Rajasthan.